

# PostProcessing\_evaluator

An isolated workspace to build publication-ready postprocessing  
Field inventory, SWC sampling, front-aware analysis — without touching the official pipeline

Nicole Flores

KAUST

May 13, 2026

# Outline

- 1 Why a PostProcessing evaluator
- 2 What is protected
- 3 Evaluator structure
- 4 First-pass field inventory
- 5 Recovered workflow
- 6 Planned analyses
- 7 Safety boundary

# Why this evaluator exists

## Goal

Develop and validate postprocessing tools that extract time-dependent values along simulated neuronal geometries, and identify quantities + figures suitable for publication.

## Problem with the old organization

The original outputs landed under `/scratch/flore0a/AnalysisResults/` without timestamps, without a manifest, and without a clean separation between raw and enriched data. Scripts were duplicated in two locations (`Postanalysis_swc/` and `Value_Extraction/`, byte-identical).

## Approach

Stand up an evaluator workspace that **leaves the official pipeline untouched** and produces **timestamped, manifested** outputs to scratch. The official pipeline remains the ground-truth reference until the evaluator is validated.

# Hard boundaries

## Never modified

- `/project/.../plugins/Growth_Plugin/python_utils/PostProcessing`  
— the official Python postprocessing pipeline.
- `/project/.../apps/Neuronal_Process/PostProcessing`  
— the older app-side mirror.
- `/project/.../apps/Neuronal_Process/Scripts_lua/Model_only_final_steps.lua`  
— and any production Lua.
- `/scratch/flore0a/AnalysisResults`  
— historical postprocessing outputs (read-only reference).

## Allowed

- Read everything above.
- Write only inside `/project/.../PostProcessing_evaluator/`

# Layout (project side)

|                                   |                                                  |
|-----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| PostProcessing_evaluator/         |                                                  |
| README.md                         |                                                  |
| copied_reference/                 | (frozen, chmod 0444)                             |
| README_PROVENANCE.md              |                                                  |
| old_analysisresults_scripts/      | (the 4 scripts that<br>produced AnalysisResults) |
| scripts/                          |                                                  |
| inspect_simulation_fields.py      | (NEW; autodetect fields)                         |
| reproduction/                     |                                                  |
| run_chain.py                      | (NEW; orchestrator)                              |
| sh_files/                         | (login-node runners)                             |
| slurm/                            | (Shaheen jobs; srun+pvpython)                    |
| presentation/                     |                                                  |
| configs/, reports/, tests/, logs/ |                                                  |

# Layout (scratch side)

```
/scratch/flore0a/PostProcessing_evaluator/  
  inputs/      outputs/      figures/      tables/  
  reports/                (timestamped MD + CSV reports)  
  runs/<TS>/              (one inspection run per timestamp)  
  reproduction_runs/<TS>/ (one full reproduction per timestamp)  
  logs/                  (SLURM and login-node logs)  
  temporary/
```

Every output directory carries a YYYYMMDD\_HHMMSS stamp. The historical AnalysisResults/ is never written to.

# Stage 1: `inspect_simulation_fields.py`

## What it does

Read-only inspection of one simulation directory.

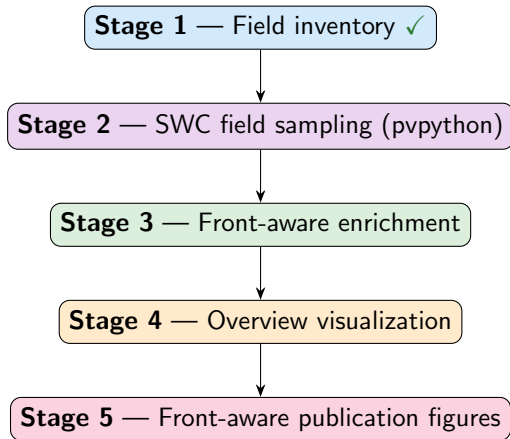
- Autodetects `Simulation.vtkhdf`, `merged/Output_t*.vtu`, `*.pvtu`.
- Enumerates timesteps and time values.
- For every point-data, cell-data, and field-data array: reports min, max, mean, std,  $n_{\text{tuples}}$ , and counts of NaN / Inf.
- Vector arrays are reported per-component plus magnitude.

## Outputs

`/scratch/.../PostProcessing_evaluator/runs/<TS>/`

- `field_inventory.csv` — long format.
- `field_inventory.md` — per-step compact tables.
- `run_metadata.json` — command, executable, VTK version, hostname.

# Workflow stages (recovered from AnalysisResults)



**Stage 1** is new evaluator code. **Stages 2–5** are the 4 frozen scripts that produced AnalysisResults (verified via IA\_session\_report\_20260503\_153249.md).



## Stages 6–8 (frozen reference, deferred)

### Stage 6 — Morphometric extraction

`compute_morphometrics.py` (frozen). Per-frame morphometric features.

### Stage 7 — Multivariate / statistical analysis

`analyze_morphometrics.py` (frozen).  $D \times V$  parameter study, correlations, PCA, marginal effects, interaction terms.

### Stage 8 — Mosaic / matrix visualization

`matrix.py` (frozen). Mosaic GIF assembly across cases.

Stages 6–8 need the full multi-case `Dataset_test*` tree, not a single case. `AnalysisResults` only contains `D7.5_V3`.

# Publication-oriented analyses (planned)

- 1 **Front-aware kymographs** (Stage 5 figA\_\*) — tubulin / MAP2 / calcium / inhibitor along path-length over time.
- 2 **Growth-cone dynamics** (figC) — concentrations localized at the growth cone vs time; pair with elongation rate.
- 3 **Elongation rate vs concentration** (figD) — the coupling figure:  $dL/dt$  at lag-1 vs growth-cone concentration.
- 4 **L\_max plateau** — D7.5\_V3 plateaus at  $L_{\max} \approx 3.05$  from frame  $\sim 5$ ; not currently a figure but visible in `summary_report.txt`.
- 5 **Pixel-vs-clean skeleton agreement** — quantitative comparison of the two variants (currently visual only).
- 6 **Cross-case stability** — inspect every  $D * _V*$  in `Dataset_test{2,3,4}`; build per-field consistency reports.

# Safety summary

## Confirmed this session (read-only setup)

- Official PostProcessing modified: ✗ **NO**.
- AnalysisResults modified: ✗ **NO**.
- Production Lua modified: ✗ **NO**.
- Existing results overwritten: ✗ **NO**.
- Frozen reference (copied\_reference/) `chmod 0444`.

## Standing operational rules followed

- All SLURM scripts: `--mail-user=elsanicole.florespretell@kaust.edu.sa`, `--mail-type=ALL`.
- All compute-node writes to `/scratch/` only.
- All `pvpython` invocations under `srun --ntasks=1`.
- All outputs timestamped `YYYYMMDD_HHMMSS`.

## Next steps (await user authorization)

- 1 Submit Stage 1 inspection on D7.5\_V3 (`sbatch run_inspect_simulation_fields.slurm`).
- 2 Submit reproduction (`VARIANT=clean` first; then `pixel`).
- 3 Generate `reproduction_comparison_<TS>.md` comparing reproduced outputs vs `/scratch/flore0a/AnalysisResults`.
- 4 Extend to additional  $D * _V$  cases.